AL301
TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

UNIT 2 • COMPLETE DETAILED NOTES

Types of Communication • Non-verbal Communication • Barriers • Culture & Global Communication
Interpersonal Skills • Listening • Persuasion • Negotiation • Bad-News Messages

STUDENT-FRIENDLY STUDY EDITION
Concept maps • Colour-coded summaries • Examples • Tables • Practice questions

How to use these notes
Read the concept in sequence, study the colour diagrams, learn the examples, and revise from the quick recap and question bank at the end. These notes follow the Unit 2 topics visible in the supplied AL301 Technical Communication syllabus.

1. Unit 2 at a Glance

A roadmap to the concepts in this unit

Communication is the process of creating shared meaning. Unit 2 moves from the forms of communication to the human skills that make communication effective in classrooms, workplaces and multicultural settings.



Learning outcomes

- Differentiate verbal, non-verbal and written communication, and identify major forms of non-verbal cues.
- Recognise physical, semantic, psychological, cultural and organisational barriers and choose ways to reduce them.
- Explain how culture influences language, time, hierarchy, feedback, gestures and business etiquette.
- Apply interpersonal communication, active listening, persuasion and negotiation skills.
- Choose a suitable approach for communicating difficult or bad news professionally.

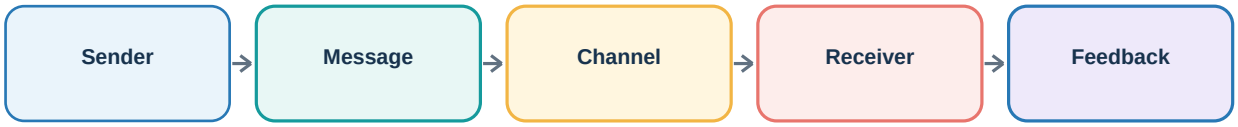
Key vocabulary

Term	Simple meaning	Workplace example
Encoding	Turning an idea into words, symbols or actions.	A lecturer explains a lab task.
Decoding	Interpreting the message received.	A student understands the task.
Feedback	A response that shows how a message was understood.	A student asks a clarifying question.
Context	The situation surrounding communication.	A formal email differs from a friendly chat.
Noise	Anything that disturbs meaning.	Loud construction outside a classroom.

Exam tip
For a 5- or 10-mark answer, define the concept, classify it, explain each point, add a practical example, and finish with its importance.

2. Forms of Communication: The Big Picture

Communication can be classified according to the channel used, the number of participants, the direction of information flow and the degree of formality. In real life, several forms operate together: a teacher may speak, use slides, gesture and invite questions in the same lesson.



Main classifications

Basis	Types	Illustration
Mode / channel	Verbal, non-verbal, visual, written	Conversation, gesture, chart, email
Participants	Intrapersonal, interpersonal, group, public, mass	Self-talk, pair discussion, lecture, TV broadcast
Formality	Formal and informal	Official circular vs friendly chat
Direction in an organisation	Downward, upward, horizontal, diagonal	Manager instructions; employee feedback; peer coordination
Feedback pattern	One-way and two-way	Recorded announcement vs interactive discussion

Verbal communication

Verbal communication uses words, either spoken or written. Oral communication includes conversations, lectures, interviews, meetings, telephone calls and presentations. Written communication includes emails, reports, notices, letters, minutes and messages. Words provide explicit content, while tone, pace and context influence how the content is understood.

Non-verbal communication

Non-verbal communication conveys meaning without relying only on words. Facial expressions, eye behaviour, gestures, posture, physical distance, touch, voice qualities, appearance, silence and the use of time can strengthen, qualify or contradict a verbal message.

> **Remember**
> Effective communication is not simply sending information. It is checking whether the receiver has understood the intended meaning.

3. Verbal Communication: Spoken and Written

Verbal communication is useful when a message needs words to explain facts, instructions, opinions or emotions. Its effectiveness depends on the choice of words, structure, tone, audience and opportunity for feedback.

Oral communication	Written communication
Usually immediate and interactive.	Can be planned, edited and stored.
Tone and instant feedback can clarify meaning.	A permanent record can support accountability.
Useful for discussion, interviews and urgent coordination.	Useful for policies, instructions, reports and formal decisions.
May be forgotten or misunderstood if not documented.	Can sound impersonal; feedback may be delayed.

Principles of effective verbal communication

- **Clarity:** use familiar words and a logical sequence.
- **Conciseness:** remove repetition while retaining necessary details.
- **Correctness:** verify names, dates, figures, grammar and facts.
- **Completeness:** include what the receiver needs to act.
- **Courtesy:** use respectful language, even when disagreeing.
- **Concreteness:** replace vague claims with specific information.
- **Audience awareness:** adapt technical vocabulary and detail to the listener.

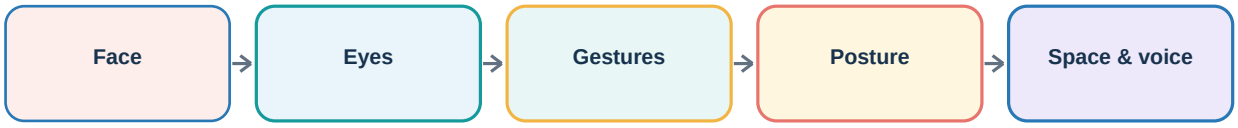
Example: unclear vs clear instruction

Less effective	More effective
“Submit it soon.”	“Please upload the lab report to the LMS by 4 p.m. on Thursday.”
“Your work is not good.”	“Your report needs a clearer objective, labelled figures and two credible references.”
“Everyone knows this.”	“As discussed in Monday’s class, use the following three steps…”

Practical check
Before sending a message, ask: Who is receiving it? What action is needed? By when? What could be misunderstood?

4. Non-verbal Communication (NVC)

Non-verbal communication includes signals that communicate meaning without words or alongside words. These signals can show interest, confidence, discomfort, respect, urgency and emotional state. Their meaning is not universal: the same gesture can be interpreted differently across cultures and situations.



Functions of non-verbal cues

Function	What it does	Example
Repeating	Says the same thing as words.	Saying “this way” while pointing.
Complementing	Adds detail to spoken words.	A warm smile supports a welcome.
Substituting	Replaces words.	A nod may mean “yes” or “I understand.”
Regulating	Manages turns in conversation.	Looking toward a speaker can invite them to continue.
Contradicting	Conflicts with spoken words.	Saying “I’m fine” with a tense voice and withdrawn posture.
Emphasising	Highlights a point.	A deliberate hand movement underlines a key idea.

Why NVC matters

- It helps speakers appear attentive and approachable.
- It provides clues about whether a listener is following the message.
- It can make presentations more engaging and easier to understand.
- It supports rapport, but should not be treated as a perfect way to read someone’s thoughts.

> **Important caution**
> Never judge a person’s honesty, interest or personality from one isolated gesture. Consider the context, culture, individual habits and other signals together.

5. Major Categories of Non-verbal Communication

Category	Meaning	Example / professional use
Kinesics	Body movement: facial expression, gesture, posture and head movement.	Use natural gestures and an open posture while presenting.
Oculesics	Eye behaviour and eye contact.	Look toward the audience without staring or forcing eye contact.
Proxemics	Use of interpersonal distance and space.	Respect personal space during a conversation.
Haptics	Communication through touch.	A handshake may be a greeting where culturally appropriate.
Paralanguage	Vocal features other than the words: pitch, volume, pace, pauses and voice quality.	Slow down when explaining a difficult concept.
Chronemics	Use and interpretation of time.	Arriving punctually communicates reliability in many settings.
Appearance / artefacts	Clothing, grooming, objects and visual presentation.	Dress appropriately for an interview or formal meeting.
Silence	A pause or absence of speech that may communicate thought, respect, hesitation or disagreement.	Allow a pause after asking a question.

Body language in a classroom or meeting

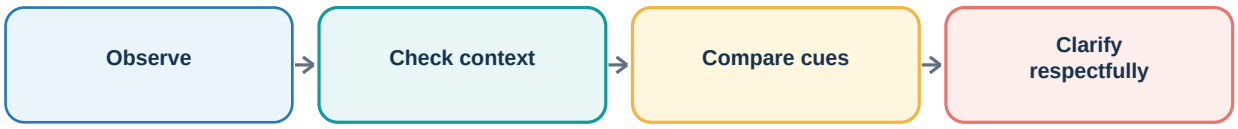
- Face the audience and keep shoulders relaxed.
- Use gestures to support ideas, not to distract from them.
- Avoid reading every line from slides; look up regularly.
- Notice group signals, but ask a respectful question instead of assuming what a person feels.
- Match vocal energy to the room and the purpose of the message.

> **Example**
> A presenter says, “I welcome questions,” but looks at the floor, speaks too softly and turns away. The words invite participation, while the non-verbal signals may unintentionally discourage it.

6. Interpreting and Improving Non-verbal Signals

Non-verbal cues are most reliable when interpreted as patterns rather than single signs. A folded arm, for example, may indicate discomfort, but it may also simply mean the room is cold. Professional communicators observe, remain curious and clarify when needed.

A practical observation framework



Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use a natural, attentive expression.	Forcing a permanent smile.
Adjust volume so everyone can hear.	Shouting or speaking so quietly that listeners struggle.
Allow culturally appropriate eye contact.	Assuming every culture expects the same eye-contact pattern.
Keep a balanced, comfortable posture.	Treating one posture as proof of a particular emotion.
Observe whether the audience seems confused and invite questions.	Labelling a listener “rude” merely because they are quiet.

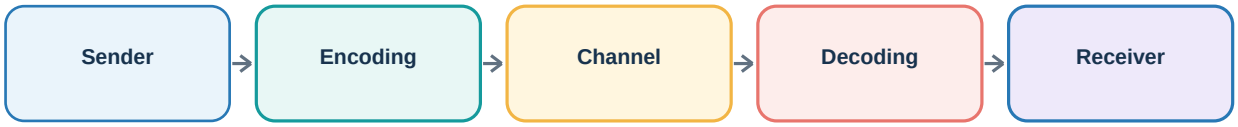
Online non-verbal communication

- Position the camera near eye level and keep the face adequately lit.
- Mute the microphone when not speaking and avoid distracting background movement.
- Use facial expression and voice deliberately because many body cues are not visible online.
- Use clear subject lines, punctuation and considerate response timing in digital messages.
- Do not rely on emojis alone for serious or sensitive workplace messages.

Mini activity
In pairs, deliver the same sentence—“That is an interesting idea”—with three different tones. Discuss how pitch, pace, facial expression and context change its meaning.

7. Barriers to Communication

A communication barrier is anything that prevents a message from being sent, received or interpreted as intended. Barriers can occur at any stage: a sender may frame an unclear message, a channel may fail, or a receiver may interpret the message through assumptions.



Common barriers and solutions

Barrier	How it appears	Ways to reduce it
Physical / environmental	Noise, poor lighting, distance, faulty microphone.	Choose a suitable place, test equipment, reduce noise.
Semantic / language	Jargon, ambiguous words, unfamiliar accents, poor translation.	Use plain language, define terms, paraphrase and confirm.
Psychological / emotional	Anxiety, anger, fear, low confidence, prejudice.	Pause, listen without judgement, build trust and choose timing.
Physiological	Hearing difficulty, fatigue, illness, speech difficulty.	Make reasonable accommodations, provide written support, take breaks.
Cultural	Different meanings, etiquette, time expectations and values.	Ask respectfully, learn norms, avoid stereotypes.
Organisational	Too many approval layers, unclear authority, information silos.	Clarify responsibilities and channels; encourage upward feedback.
Technological	Weak internet, incompatible platforms, notification overload.	Test the platform, share backup information, summarise decisions.
Information overload	Too many details or messages at once.	Prioritise, structure, chunk information and state actions clearly.

Core principle
Do not simply blame the receiver. Improve the message, the channel and the opportunity for feedback.

8. Language, Psychological and Organisational Barriers

Semantic barriers arise when people attach different meanings to the same words or symbols. Technical terms may be precise for experts but confusing for beginners. Words such as “soon,” “adequate” or “urgent” can also mean different things to different people.

Examples of semantic barriers

- **Jargon:** specialist language that an audience may not know.
- **Ambiguity:** a sentence with more than one possible meaning.
- **Different language proficiency:** the receiver may know the topic but not the vocabulary.
- **Overly complex sentences:** multiple ideas make the action difficult to identify.
- **Faulty translation:** a translated phrase may not preserve tone or intended meaning.

Psychological barriers

Emotions influence both sending and receiving. A worried student may not ask a question; an angry manager may hear feedback as an attack; a person who expects criticism may interpret neutral comments negatively. Stereotypes and confirmation bias can also lead people to notice only information that supports their existing beliefs.

Organisational barriers

Rigid hierarchy can discourage employees from sharing concerns. Departmental silos may prevent teams from seeing the same facts. Unclear roles can lead to duplicated work, while excessive formalities can delay urgent decisions. Informal rumours may fill gaps when official communication is slow.

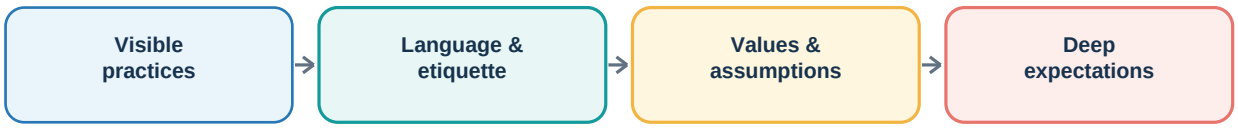
Problematic message	Improved version
“Do the needful ASAP.”	“Please check the attached attendance sheet and send the corrected version by 2 p.m. today.”
“The report is wrong.”	“The total in Table 2 does not match the figures in the appendix. Please verify it.”
“No one told me.”	“I may have missed the update. Could you confirm which channel was used?”

A useful habit
Use the teach-back method for important instructions: ask the receiver to explain the next steps in their own words, without making them feel tested.

9. Culture and Communication

Culture is a shared set of values, beliefs, practices, expectations and learned behaviours. It can influence greetings, politeness, disagreement, personal space, eye contact, punctuality, silence, hierarchy and decision-making. Culture is not limited to nationality: family, profession, generation, region and organisation can also shape communication.

Culture's visible and less-visible layers



Cultural differences that may affect communication

Dimension	Possible difference	Helpful response
Directness	Some speakers state disagreement explicitly; others soften it.	Focus on meaning and ask for clarification politely.
Hierarchy	Some settings expect formal titles and deference; others favour informality.	Observe preferred forms of address and decision routes.
Time	Punctuality and scheduling flexibility may be valued differently.	Agree on deadlines and communicate changes early.
Silence	A pause may signal thought, respect, discomfort or a wish to speak.	Allow time; do not rush to fill every pause.
Personal space	Comfortable conversational distance can vary.	Follow the other person's cues and respect boundaries.
Feedback	Some people prefer direct correction; others prefer private or softened feedback.	Give specific, respectful feedback in a suitable setting.

Avoid stereotypes
Cultural patterns are tendencies, not rules for every individual. Ask, observe and adapt instead of assuming someone behaves a certain way because of their background.

10. Communicating in a Global World

Global communication happens when people work, study or collaborate across countries, languages, time zones and cultural expectations. Online meetings, international supply chains, remote teams and global education make intercultural competence an everyday professional skill.

Best practices for global communication

- **Use plain international English:** avoid idioms, slang, obscure humour and unnecessary abbreviations.
- **Speak at a measured pace:** pause between major points and pronounce key terms clearly.
- **Make writing scannable:** use informative subject lines, headings, short paragraphs and action bullets.
- **Check understanding:** summarise decisions and invite questions without embarrassment.
- **Respect time zones:** rotate meeting times where possible and record key outcomes.
- **Be careful with humour:** jokes, irony and sarcasm may not translate well.
- **Confirm dates and units:** write dates unambiguously, such as “12 October 2026,” and specify time zones.
- **Use inclusive participation:** give quieter members time and more than one way to contribute.

Example: global project email

> **Subject: Design review — action items due 16 October**
> Hello team,
>
> Thank you for today’s review. Please upload the revised diagrams to the shared folder by **16 October, 17:00 IST**. Add a short note describing each change. If the deadline is difficult, reply by tomorrow so that we can agree on a plan. I have listed the decisions and owners below.
>
> Best regards,
> Project Coordinator

Digital etiquette in cross-border teams

Choose synchronous communication (live call) when nuance, discussion or rapid clarification matters. Choose asynchronous communication (email, shared document or recorded update) when people need time to review information or work across time zones. Document decisions so that team members who could not attend can still contribute.

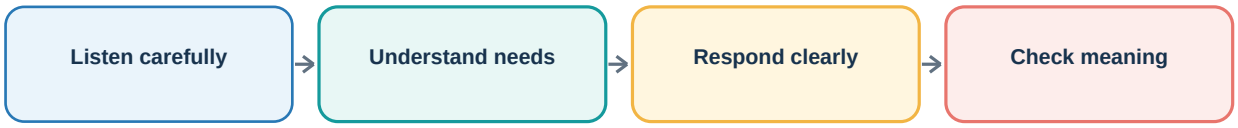
11. Interpersonal Communication

Interpersonal communication is the exchange of information, feelings and meaning between two or more people who can respond to one another. It occurs in student–teacher interactions, interviews, meetings, teamwork, counselling, customer service and everyday relationships.

Qualities of effective interpersonal communication

Quality	Meaning	Example
Empathy	Trying to understand another person's perspective.	"It sounds as though the deadline has been difficult."
Respect	Recognising the other person's dignity and rights.	Disagreeing without insults.
Assertiveness	Expressing needs clearly while respecting others.	"I can help after I finish the lab assessment."
Openness	Being willing to exchange ideas and ask questions.	Inviting a colleague to suggest a better method.
Feedback	Sharing specific observations about impact or performance.	"Your opening was clear; add an example in the second section."
Adaptability	Changing style to suit audience and context.	Explaining a technical term to a first-year student.

A simple interpersonal communication cycle



Assertive, passive and aggressive styles

Style	Typical pattern	Likely impact
Passive	Avoids expressing needs; agrees despite concerns.	Needs may remain unmet; resentment may build.
Aggressive	Uses blame, threats or disrespect to get a result.	Damages trust and invites defensiveness.
Assertive	Clear, calm, direct and respectful.	Supports boundaries, cooperation and problem-solving.

Useful sentence frame
"When [specific situation] happens, it affects [impact]. Could we [clear request]?" Example: "When the meeting starts late, we lose review time. Could we begin at 10 a.m. as planned?"

12. Listening Skills and Active Listening

Hearing is the physical process of receiving sound; listening is the active process of attending to, interpreting, evaluating and responding to a message. Effective listening requires concentration and an intention to understand before replying.



Types of listening

Type	Purpose	Example
Discriminative	Notice differences in sounds, tone or emphasis.	Recognising a change in a speaker's voice.
Informational	Understand and retain information.	Listening to lab instructions.
Critical	Assess evidence and reasoning.	Evaluating a proposal's strengths and weaknesses.
Empathetic	Understand another person's feelings and perspective.	Listening to a stressed student without rushing to judge.
Appreciative	Enjoy or value the experience.	Listening to a speech, story or performance.

Active listening behaviours

- Give attention: reduce distractions, put away unnecessary notifications and face the speaker.
- Use brief encouragers such as "I see," "go on" or a natural nod, where appropriate.
- Paraphrase: "So the main issue is that the instructions changed after the deadline."
- Ask open questions: "What part of the process caused the delay?"
- Reflect feelings carefully: "It sounds frustrating to repeat the work."
- Summarise agreements and next steps before ending the discussion.

> **The 70/30 reminder**
> In a difficult conversation, aim to give the other person enough space to explain their view. The exact ratio is not a rule; the goal is balanced participation and accurate understanding.

13. Barriers to Listening and How to Overcome Them

Listening barrier	What happens	Practical remedy
Distraction	Attention moves to phones, noise or side conversations.	Remove distractions and choose a quieter place.
Premature judgement	The listener decides the answer before hearing the full message.	Delay evaluation until the speaker finishes.
Rehearsing a reply	The listener plans a comeback instead of understanding.	Write a keyword if needed; return attention to the speaker.
Emotional reaction	Anger, fear or embarrassment blocks careful interpretation.	Pause, breathe, name the issue calmly and continue when ready.
Information overload	Too many details exceed working memory.	Ask for a summary, take notes and group information.
Assumptions	The listener fills gaps with guesses or stereotypes.	Ask a neutral clarifying question.
Selective listening	Only preferred or familiar details are noticed.	Summarise the full message, including inconvenient points.
Language difficulty	Unfamiliar vocabulary or accent obscures meaning.	Request repetition, simpler wording or written confirmation.

Listening in lectures and meetings

- Preview the topic and note the purpose before the session.
- Record key ideas, examples, questions and action items rather than every word.
- Use headings or a two-column note format: “main idea” and “evidence/example.”
- At the end, summarise three takeaways and identify anything still unclear.
- When giving feedback, describe what you heard before adding your opinion.

Practice: listen–paraphrase–question

Speaker: “Our team keeps missing deadlines because the task owner changes and updates are spread across different chats.”
Paraphrase: “The main problem is unclear ownership and scattered updates.”
Question: “Would one shared task tracker with a named owner for each item help?”

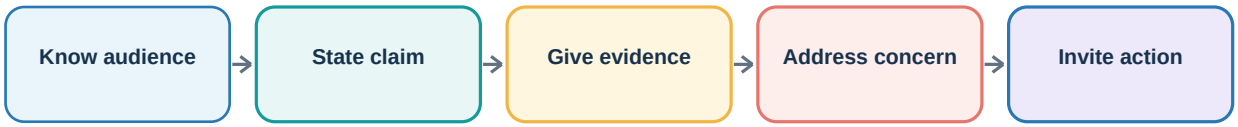
> **Exam distinction**
> Listening is an active communication skill; it includes attention, interpretation, evaluation, memory and response—not just hearing sounds.

14. Persuasion: Influencing with Reasons and Trust

Persuasion is the process of influencing a person's beliefs, attitudes or actions through communication. Ethical persuasion provides relevant evidence, explains benefits, acknowledges concerns and respects the audience's freedom to decide. It is different from manipulation, which hides important facts or uses pressure unfairly.

Three classical appeals

Appeal	Focus	Example
Ethos	Credibility and trustworthiness of the speaker.	A qualified trainer explains the basis for a safety recommendation.
Logos	Logic, evidence, facts and reasoning.	A proposal compares costs, timelines and measurable outcomes.
Pathos	Emotion, values and human relevance.	A story shows how a service helps students feel included.



A practical persuasion structure

- **Attention:** open with a relevant problem, question or brief fact.
- **Need:** explain why the issue matters to this audience.
- **Solution:** offer a specific and realistic proposal.
- **Evidence:** support the proposal with examples, data or expert reasoning.
- **Objections:** acknowledge the strongest reasonable concern and respond honestly.
- **Action:** state the next step clearly.

Example: persuade a class to use a shared study calendar

"We sometimes miss submission dates because information is spread across messages. A shared calendar would list each task, its owner and the deadline in one place. We can test it for two weeks and review whether it reduces confusion. If it adds unnecessary work, we can simplify it. Shall we try it for the next assignment?"

> **Ethical checklist**
> Is the information accurate? Are limitations disclosed? Is the request fair? Can the audience say no without being punished? If not, revise the approach.

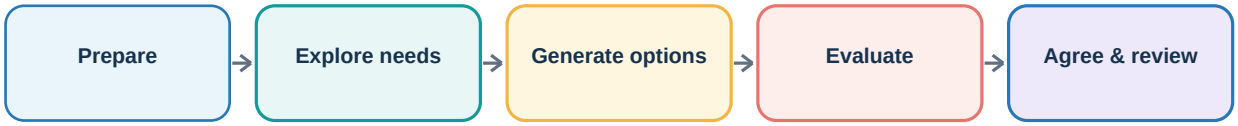
15. Negotiation Skills

Negotiation is a communication process in which two or more parties discuss differences and seek an agreement. It is common in project planning, workload allocation, deadlines, salary discussions, resource sharing and conflict resolution. A good negotiation protects essential interests while exploring solutions acceptable to both sides.

Positions versus interests

Term	Meaning	Example
Position	What a party says it wants.	“I need the report by Friday.”
Interest	The reason behind the request.	“I need time to verify the figures before Monday’s review.”
Option	A possible solution.	Submit a draft Friday and verified final version Monday.
Objective criterion	A fair standard used to evaluate options.	Policy, workload data, agreed quality standards.

A five-stage negotiation process



Principles of constructive negotiation

- Prepare goals, facts, priorities, alternatives and the limits of what you can accept.
- Separate the people from the problem; criticise the issue, not the person.
- Ask questions to understand needs before proposing a solution.
- Generate more than one option rather than arguing over a single demand.
- Use fair criteria and explain the reasoning behind your proposal.
- Confirm who will do what, by when, and how the agreement will be reviewed.

> **Useful phrase**
> “I understand why that date matters. Could we explore a staged submission that protects your review time and gives us enough time for quality checks?”

16. Negotiation, Conflict and Difficult Conversations

Conflict is not always harmful. When handled respectfully, it can reveal unclear expectations and produce better decisions. It becomes destructive when participants attack character, withhold information, threaten, interrupt or treat compromise as defeat.

Common approaches to conflict

Approach	When it may fit	Risk if overused
Collaborating	The issue matters to both sides and time is available.	Can take longer than the situation allows.
Compromising	Both sides can accept a middle-ground outcome.	May leave the deeper problem unresolved.
Accommodating	The issue matters more to the other person or preserving goodwill is important.	Your legitimate needs may be ignored.
Competing / directing	Urgent action or a firm safety rule is required.	Can damage trust if used unnecessarily.
Avoiding / postponing	Emotions are too high or the issue is minor and timing is poor.	The issue may grow if never revisited.

De-escalation steps

- Lower the pace and volume of your voice.
- Describe the observable issue rather than assigning motives.
- Acknowledge the other person's concern without pretending to agree.
- Identify the shared goal, such as accuracy, fairness or student learning.
- Offer two or three realistic options and invite the other person's view.
- Write down the agreed actions and follow-up date.

Example: workload disagreement

Instead of: "You always give me extra work at the last minute."
Try: "Three additional tasks came in after Tuesday's schedule was finalised. I can complete the report today or prepare the presentation first. Which is the priority, and can we agree on a process for late requests?"

> **Boundary reminder**
> Being polite does not mean agreeing to everything. State limits respectfully and offer alternatives when possible.

17. Communicating Bad News and Negative Messages

A bad-news message communicates information the receiver may find disappointing, inconvenient or upsetting: a rejected request, a delay, a policy change, a complaint outcome or an unsuccessful application. The communicator's task is to be truthful, considerate and clear while preserving professional relationships.

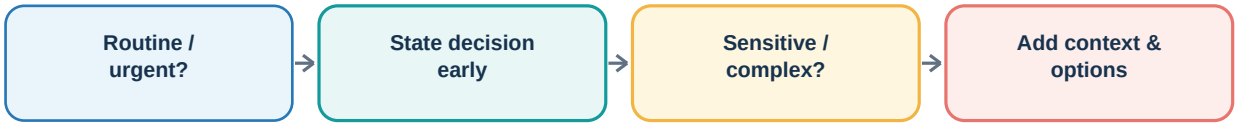
Choose the message strategy

Strategy	Structure	Suitable when
Direct approach	Main decision first → brief reasons → alternatives / next steps → courteous close.	The issue is routine, the audience expects a clear answer, or urgency matters.
Indirect approach	Neutral opening → context and reasons → decision clearly stated → alternatives / next steps → courteous close.	The news may be disappointing and context can help the reader understand it.

Guidelines for delivering bad news

- Be accurate and timely; do not hide the decision behind vague wording.
- Explain the reason at an appropriate level of detail without blaming or exposing private information.
- Use respectful language and acknowledge the impact where appropriate.
- Avoid false hope, excessive apologies or promises you cannot keep.
- Offer alternatives, support, an appeal route or a practical next step if available.
- Choose a private conversation for sensitive personal matters; follow it with written confirmation when necessary.

A simple decision map



Tone matters
A bad-news message should be neither cold nor misleading. Be humane in tone and firm about facts.

18. Bad-News Message: Models and Examples

Example A: Direct message about a missed deadline

> **Subject: Revised submission date**
> Hello team,
>
> The final report will not be ready for today's 3 p.m. review because the verification stage is incomplete. The review has been moved to **10 a.m. tomorrow**. Please use today to check the figures and upload any corrections by 6 p.m. I will share an updated agenda this afternoon.
>
> Thank you for your cooperation.

Why it works: the decision and new timing are clear; the reason is brief; the next action is specific.

Example B: Indirect message declining a request

> **Subject: Request for additional lab slot**
> Dear Student,
>
> Thank you for explaining your request for an additional lab slot. The current timetable has all available laboratory periods assigned, and the room must remain available for scheduled practicals. For this reason, I am unable to approve an extra slot this week. You may attend the next available supervised practice session on Monday, subject to confirmation. Please contact the lab coordinator if you need help identifying a suitable group.
>
> Regards,
> Course Coordinator

Why it works: it acknowledges the request, gives a neutral reason, states the refusal plainly and offers a realistic next step.

Example C: Giving constructive negative feedback

"Your presentation topic is relevant and your opening is engaging. At present, the slides contain too much text, so the main argument is difficult to follow. Please reduce each slide to key phrases, add one example to support your main claim, and rehearse within the allotted time. We can review the revised version on Thursday."

Common mistakes to avoid

- Being so indirect that the reader cannot identify the decision.
- Using accusatory phrases such as "You failed to…" when a neutral description will do.
- Giving a reason that is untrue or revealing confidential details.
- Ending without a next step when a useful alternative is available.

19. Quick Revision Sheet & Exam Practice

One-minute recap

Topic	Remember
Verbal communication	Uses words; oral and written forms each have strengths and limitations.
Non-verbal communication	Includes kinesics, oculesics, proxemics, haptics, paralanguage, chronemics, appearance and silence.
Functions of NVC	Repeats, complements, substitutes, regulates, contradicts or emphasises verbal messages.
Barriers	Physical, semantic, psychological, physiological, cultural, organisational, technological and overload.
Culture & global communication	Use plain language, clarify expectations, respect difference and avoid stereotypes.
Interpersonal communication	Empathy, respect, assertiveness, feedback and adaptability support relationships.
Listening	Receive, attend, interpret, evaluate and respond; paraphrase and ask clarifying questions.
Persuasion	Use credibility, logic and appropriate emotional relevance ethically.
Negotiation	Explore interests, generate options, use fair criteria and document agreements.
Bad-news messages	Be truthful, clear and considerate; choose a direct or indirect structure based on context.

Long-answer questions

- Explain verbal and non-verbal communication with examples. Discuss the major categories of non-verbal communication.
- What are communication barriers? Explain different types and suggest practical remedies.
- Discuss the role of culture in communication and describe strategies for effective global communication.
- Define active listening. Explain its stages, types, barriers and improvement techniques.
- What is persuasion? Explain ethos, logos and pathos with suitable examples.
- Describe the stages of negotiation and explain how conflict can be managed constructively.
- Explain direct and indirect approaches to communicating bad news, with suitable message examples.

Short-answer / viva questions

- Differentiate hearing and listening.
- What is proxemics? Give one example.
- Name any four functions of non-verbal communication.
- What is semantic noise?
- Differentiate assertive and aggressive communication.
- Why should idioms be limited in global communication?
- What is the difference between a position and an interest in negotiation?
- Mention two features of an effective bad-news message.

Final exam formula
Definition → classification / process → explanation of points → relevant example → importance / conclusion.
Use headings and underline key terms in handwritten answers.

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